queries; figure 2.16 shows an example. The notable point is that `aggs` is the root-level object, with an `avg` (average) metric defined on an `amazon_rating` field. Once this query is executed, it returns the aggregated results to the user. Let's jump right into executing some metric aggregations.

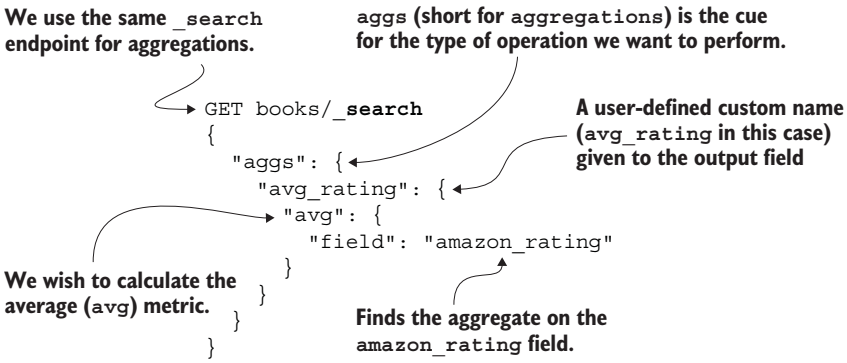
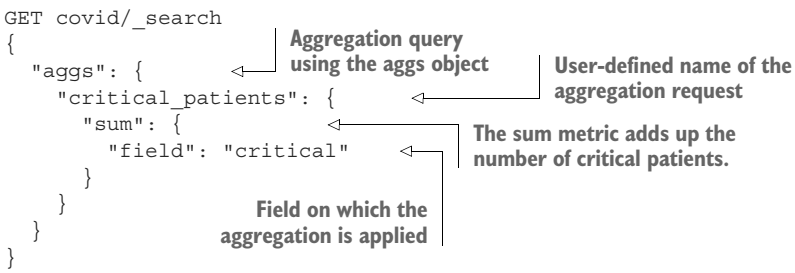


Figure 2.16 Query DSL syntax for finding an average rating aggregation

FINDING THE TOTAL NUMBER OF CRITICAL PATIENTS (SUM METRIC)

Going back to our COVID data, suppose we want to find the total number of critical patients across all 10 countries. For that, we use the following `sum` metric.

Listing 2.26 Fetching the total number of critical patients



With this snippet, we create an aggregation-type query; aggs is the cue for Elasticsearch that this is an aggregation task. The sum metric is the type of aggregation we intend to carry out. Here we are asking the engine to find the total number of critical patients by adding the number for each of the countries. The response is something like this:

```
"aggregations" : {
  "critical_patients" : {
    "value" : 44045.0
  }
}
```